

Personal Assistant User Manual

Pandoras Box -- User Documentation

Version 1.0 | pandoras-box.ai

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Version: 1.0 **Audience:** Anyone using the Personal Assistant for daily life and work

Disclaimer

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1. What Is a Personal Assistant?

Your Personal Assistant is an AI that knows you.

Not just your calendar and your inbox -- your preferences, your working patterns, your ongoing projects, your conversations over the past weeks. Unlike a chatbot that starts from a blank slate every time you open it, your Personal Assistant maintains context across conversations.

This is what makes it useful in a way that general-purpose AI tools are not.

A general-purpose AI chatbot can write a poem about autumn. Your Personal Assistant can write a poem about autumn that references the walk you mentioned last Tuesday, in the voice you have been

developing for your newsletter.

A general-purpose AI can draft a professional email. Your Personal Assistant can draft a reply to the email from Sarah at Company B, knowing that your last three interactions were tense, that you have a meeting scheduled for next week, and that your preferred tone in these situations is measured and factual.

That is the difference. Context is everything.

2. The Morning Briefing

Every morning, before you start your day, your Personal Assistant prepares a briefing.

It runs automatically at 07:30 (configurable). When you open your relay channel, the briefing is waiting for you.

What a morning briefing includes

- **Today's calendar:** every event, with time, location, and a one-line summary of

what you know about each meeting

- **Email summary:** what arrived overnight, grouped by company and priority
- **Open threads:** ongoing matters that need your attention today
- **Deadlines:** anything due today or tomorrow across all your companies
- **Weather:** current conditions and forecast for your location (if configured)
- **A note to start the day:** something brief and relevant -- a piece of news in your

industry, an interesting idea, or simply a prompt to begin well

Customising your briefing

You can tell your Personal Assistant what to include or exclude:

- "Stop including the weather in my briefings"
- "Add a section about [topic] to my morning briefing"
- "Move the email summary to the end"
- "I want a briefing only on working days"

Changes are remembered and applied from the next briefing onward.

3. The Personal Side

Your Personal Assistant is not only for work.

Work shutdown reminders

Your system knows your working patterns. It can prompt you to stop, step away, and rest.

Tell your Personal Assistant: "Remind me to stop working at 18:30 on weekdays. If I have been in meetings all day, also suggest I take a 10-minute break before starting admin."

The reminder arrives via your relay channel at the configured time. It knows your calendar, so it can frame the reminder contextually: "You have had four meetings today -- good time to close the laptop."

You set the rules. The Personal Assistant applies them consistently.

Brainstorming partner

Your Personal Assistant remembers what you discussed last week. Bring an idea back:

"I was thinking about the pricing model we discussed last week -- can we explore the tiered option in more detail?"

It picks up the thread. You do not re-explain context it already has.

Creative work benefits from a patient partner who never gets tired of iteration. Draft, review, revise. Ask for five alternatives. Ask for a version in a different voice. Ask what you might have missed.

Creative requests

Poetry, story ideas, writing prompts, fictional scenarios -- your Personal Assistant handles these naturally. The quality improves over time as it learns your voice and aesthetic preferences.

"Write a short poem for my daughter's birthday. She is turning 12. She loves astronomy and is currently obsessed with the idea of black holes."

It will write it. You will probably like it.

Recipe suggestions

Configure dietary preferences and seasonal awareness:

"Suggest a recipe for dinner tonight. I have chicken, lemons, and garlic. Something Mediterranean, 30 minutes or under."

Or broader:

"It is mid-October and I want to do more batch cooking on Sundays. Suggest a month of Sunday batch-cook recipes, varied, suitable for reheating on weekday evenings."

Local events

Your Personal Assistant can search for things happening near you, filtered by your interests:

"What is on in [your area] this weekend? I like live music, food markets, and outdoor activities."

Configure interest categories once, and ask for suggestions whenever you like:

"Anything worth doing near me this weekend?"

The difference from a chatbot

A chatbot does not know your week, your workload, or your preferences. It answers the question you asked, in isolation.

Your Personal Assistant contextualises. When you ask for restaurant suggestions on a Wednesday evening, it knows you have an early call Thursday. When you ask for help with a difficult email, it knows the history with that contact. When you ask for ideas for a presentation, it knows the audience from your calendar.

The suggestions are relevant to you specifically. That is the difference.

4. Tasks and Meeting Preparation

Proactive task management

Your Personal Assistant surfaces what needs attention, without you having to ask.

In your morning briefing, or on request:

"What needs my attention today?"

The response prioritises based on deadlines, calendar context, and flagged items from your email. Not just a list -- a prioritised, contextualised view.

You can also ask:

"What have I been putting off this week that I should deal with today?"

Meeting preparation

Before a meeting, your Personal Assistant can prepare a brief. Ask:

"Brief me for my 2pm."

It will pull together:

- Meeting details and attendees
- Recent relevant email from any attendee
- Open threads with anyone attending
- Any documents or proposals referenced in correspondence
- A suggested agenda if one is not already set

All in one response. Delivered before the meeting starts.

Email and document drafting

First drafts on request:

"Draft a reply to Sarah's email. Agree to the Thursday meeting, ask her to send the agenda in advance, and keep the tone warm."

"Draft a short proposal for the cloud migration project. One page, business audience, focus on cost savings and risk reduction."

You review and refine. Nothing is sent without your approval.

Business administration

- "Summarise the thread with the solicitor and list the open actions"
- "Extract the action points from the board minutes I just forwarded"
- "Draft an announcement to staff about the new holiday policy"
- "Compose a response to this complaint email -- professional, empathetic, resolving"

5. Unified Inbox

Your Personal Assistant has access to your email across all connected accounts.

Ask about any account:

- "What emails need attention across all my inboxes today?"
- "Is there anything from [person] this week?"
- "Summarise the last email from Company B's solicitor"
- "What is the status of the contract negotiation with [client]?"

Microsoft Outlook and Gmail

Both are supported. If you have both connected, your Personal Assistant treats them as one inbox unless you specify otherwise:

"Only check my Outlook inbox for now" "Show me everything from Gmail today"

What it does NOT do

Your Personal Assistant does not send email without your explicit instruction and review. When you ask it to draft a reply, it presents the draft for your approval. You confirm before anything is sent.

6. Unified Calendar

Your Personal Assistant has read and write access to your calendar.

- "What does my week look like?"
- "Find a free slot for a 30-minute call with Sarah next week, preferably morning"
- "Add a reminder for the board meeting preparation -- two days before the meeting"
- "Block out Thursday afternoon for focused work"

Microsoft Outlook Calendar and Google Calendar

Both are supported. Your Personal Assistant shows events from all connected calendars in one view.

Scheduling assistance

"I need to schedule a 1-hour strategy session with the three company directors. They are all in my contacts. What times are we all free next week?"

The Personal Assistant checks all available calendars and suggests times.

7. Research

Your Personal Assistant can search the web and synthesise information.

"What are the current VAT rules for digital services sold to EU customers?"

"Give me a briefing on [topic] -- what is the current state, what are the main debates, and what do I need to know as a business owner in the UK?"

"Who is [person/company] and what should I know before my meeting with them?"

Research responses are grounded and sourced where possible. For anything that will inform a significant decision, verify with primary sources.

8. The Browser Interface

The browser interface is a full-featured chat panel accessible from any device on your Tailscale network.

Access: `https://[your-tailscale-address]:8800`

Example caption: Example: Greek mythology theme shown.

Features:

- Full conversation history, searchable
- File upload (drag and drop a document to discuss it)
- Voice input (if configured)
- Settings panel for briefing configuration and preferences
- Links to your company agents and admin panel

The browser interface is the most capable way to interact with your Personal Assistant. The relay channel (Telegram, Discord, Slack) is faster for quick queries.

9. The Watch Companion

If you have the Watch Companion module installed, briefing summaries and alerts are delivered as watch notifications.

Supported platforms:

- Pixel Watch (Android)

The companion app delivers:

- Morning briefing summary (3-5 bullet points)
- Alerts from the Security Overseer
- Reminders you have configured

Quick replies let you respond to notifications with short predefined responses without taking your phone out.

10. Relay Options

Your Personal Assistant communicates through a relay channel. The relay is the messaging channel you chose during installation -- Telegram, Discord, or Slack.

All three are equivalent in capability. The relay is how you send messages to your Personal Assistant when you are away from the browser interface.

Switching relays

To change your relay channel, use the project system to request the change. The System Administrator will configure the new relay and migrate your settings.

Using multiple relays

You can have more than one relay active. For example, Telegram for personal use and Discord for team use. The Personal Assistant treats all relays as the same conversation.

11. Memory and Context

Your Personal Assistant maintains memory across conversations.

Short-term memory: the current conversation and the recent past (approximately the last 30 days of interactions, configurable).

Long-term memory: important facts, preferences, ongoing projects, and key context that you have explicitly asked the Personal Assistant to remember.

Storing something in memory

"Remember that my preferred format for weekly reports is bullet points, not prose."

"Remember that I am vegetarian and prefer Mediterranean food."

"Add to your memory that the Q3 board meeting is on 15 September and I need to prepare a financial summary by the 12th."

Recalling memory

Your Personal Assistant uses memory automatically in relevant contexts. You can also ask directly:

"What do you remember about my preferences for email tone?"

"What have we discussed about the expansion project?"

Clearing memory

"Forget everything you know about [topic]."

"Clear your memory about my preferences -- I want to start fresh."

12. Bolt-on Modules: Clio and Calliope

These modules extend your Personal Assistant with specialised capabilities.

Clio -- Trading and Investment Signals

Who this is for: investors, traders, anyone managing a personal or business portfolio.

What it does:

- Monitors a watchlist of instruments (stocks, indices, commodities -- depending on your connected data source)
- Tracks technical signals and event-driven triggers
- Surfaces opportunities and risks in your morning briefing as a dedicated signals section
- Responds to queries: "What is the signal on [instrument] today?"

What it does NOT do:

- Clio does not trade automatically. It surfaces signals. You review and decide.
- Every potential action requires human confirmation. There is no automated execution.

Requirements:

- Clio module installed
- Compatible brokerage or market data API credentials
- An account with a supported data provider

Cost note: Signal processing requires more frequent AI calls. Budget approximately £10-20/month additional API usage with active watchlists.

Important: Trading involves significant risk of loss. Clio provides information and signals -- not advice. You are responsible for all trading decisions and their outcomes. Nothing your Personal Assistant says constitutes financial advice.

Calliope -- Social Media and Content Publishing

Who this is for: business owners, content creators, anyone who publishes regularly.

What it does:

- Produces social posts, blog outlines, newsletter drafts, and campaign copy from a brief,

a topic, or a rough idea

- Connects to publishing channels (LinkedIn, YouTube descriptions, etc.) via API
- Schedules content on your instruction: "Publish this on Tuesday at 09:00"
- Manages a content queue: upcoming posts, scheduled items, draft backlog

What it does NOT do:

- Calliope does not post without your approval. Every piece of content goes through a

review step before it is published.

- You see the draft. You approve it. Then it publishes.

Requirements:

- Calliope module installed
- API credentials for each publishing platform you want to use

Cost note: Content generation adds moderate API usage. Budget approximately £5-15/month additional depending on publishing volume.

13. Setting Up

Your Personal Assistant is set up as part of the main installation (see the Installation Guide). After installation, there are a few things to configure:

Set your preferences

Tell your Personal Assistant your baseline preferences in the first session:

"I am [brief description of your work and life situation]. I prefer [communication style]. My typical working hours are [hours]. I have [number] companies I run. Here are my main priorities for using you: [list]."

The more context you give at the start, the more useful the responses from day one.

Configure your briefing

"My morning briefing should include: calendar for today and tomorrow, email summary, three top priorities, and the weather in [location]. No section on local events for now. Deliver it at 07:30."

Connect your relay

If you have not already done so during installation, configure your relay channel. The System Administrator can set this up via the project system.

Install the browser certificate

If the browser interface shows a security warning, install the CA certificate on the device you are using. See [docs/certificates.md](#) for full instructions.